

Origins of Islam Interactive Notebook

This is Flores's two-slide graphic organizer on the origins of Islam, listed at 18 points. Slide one has four boxes on Muhammad's life, and the directions ask for what happened plus its impact on the growth of Islam. Slide two has five boxes where Alex titles each of the Five Pillars, explains it, and adds a small image.

1 Muhammad's Background

Why would growing up in a trade city put him around lots of different beliefs?

WRITE THIS · 44 WORDS

Muhammad was born about 570 CE in Mecca, a busy trade city in Arabia. He was orphaned as a child, so relatives raised him. He became a trader and married Khadija. People called him honest. Impact: that trust helped people listen to him later.

- Slide 1
- Box 1 of 4

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The directions ask for the event AND its impact on the growth of Islam in every box, not only the last one. So each of the four answers above ends with a short impact line. If a box has room for only one sentence, the event part goes in first.

Mecca sat on a caravan trade route and was also a pilgrimage city. The Kaaba, a cube shaped shrine there, held idols for many tribes, so pilgrims meant money for Mecca's leaders. That detail pays off later in boxes 2 and 4.

2 Muhammad's Revelation and Mecca

What did Mecca's leaders stand to lose if people stopped worshipping many gods?

WRITE THIS · 44 WORDS

Around 610 CE, in a cave near Mecca, Muhammad said the angel Gabriel brought him messages from God, called Allah. He preached one God and helping the poor. Mecca's leaders rejected him and treated his followers badly. Impact: Islam started with a small group.

- Slide 1
- Box 2 of 4

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Allah is just the Arabic word for God. It is not a separate god's name. Muslims understand it as the same God worshipped in Judaism and Christianity. Worth saying out loud, because the worksheet wording can make it sound like a proper name.

The cave was on Mount Hira, outside Mecca. He was about 40.

3 Fleeing to Medina (The Hijrah)

What changed about his job once he got to Medina?

WRITE THIS · 42 WORDS

In 622 CE Muhammad and his followers left Mecca for Yathrib, later renamed Medina. This move is called the Hijrah. There he led the city as well as the religion. Impact: Islam grew into a community, and 622 begins the Muslim calendar.

- Slide 1
- Box 3 of 4

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Hijrah means migration or departure. Some books spell it Hegira. Either spelling is fine.

Medina means the city, short for city of the Prophet. Yathrib is the older name, so if the slide already says Yathrib he does not need both.

4 Muhammad's Return to Mecca

How does this box connect back to the Kaaba from box 1?

WRITE THIS · 46 WORDS

In 630 CE Muhammad returned to Mecca with a large army, and the city gave in with almost no fighting. He cleared the idols out of the Kaaba and dedicated it to the one God. Impact: most of Arabia accepted Islam. He died in 632 CE.

- Slide 1
- Box 4 of 4

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Clearing the idols is the moment that ties the four boxes together. The same shrine from box 1 is still standing, but it now points at one God instead of many.

He came with about 10,000 followers, and Mecca surrendered rather than fought, which is why accounts describe the takeover as largely peaceful.

5 Pillar 1

WRITE THIS · 31 WORDS

Shahada, the statement of faith. A Muslim says and believes: there is no god but God, and Muhammad is his messenger. Saying this honestly is what makes a person a Muslim.

- Slide 2
- Shahada

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Pronounced sha-HA-da. Also written shahadah. English name on most worksheets: Faith, or Declaration of Faith.

Shahada means testimony, like testifying to what you believe.

6 Pillar 2

WRITE THIS · 31 WORDS

Salat, daily prayer. Muslims pray five times a day, at set times, facing the city of Mecca. They wash first, and may pray at home, at work, or in a mosque.

- Slide 2
- Salat

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Pronounced sa-LAT. Also spelled salah. English name: Prayer.

The five times are set by the sun: dawn, midday, afternoon, sunset, and night. He does not need to list them, but it explains why the times shift through the year.

7 Pillar 3

WRITE THIS · 31 WORDS

Zakat, giving to the poor. Muslims give away part of the wealth they have saved, traditionally about 2.5 percent, to people in need. It counts as a duty, not a favor.

- Slide 2
- Zakat

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Pronounced za-KAT. English names vary by textbook: Charity, Almsgiving, or Alms. If Flores used a specific English word in class, use his.

Alms just means money or goods given to poor people. Worth defining, since the word only survives in this one context.

8 Pillar 4

WRITE THIS · 32 WORDS

Sawm, fasting during Ramadan. For the month of Ramadan, Muslims eat and drink nothing from dawn until sunset. It builds self control and reminds them what hunger feels like for the poor.

- Slide 2
- Sawm

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Pronounced SAWM. Also spelled saum or siyam. English name: Fasting.

Ramadan is the ninth month of the Muslim calendar, the month when the first revelations are said to have come. Because that calendar follows the moon, Ramadan moves about eleven days earlier each year.

9 Pillar 5

Now that you have all five, which one do you think would be hardest to do every single day?

WRITE THIS · 33 WORDS

Hajj, the pilgrimage to Mecca. Every Muslim who is healthy enough and can afford it should travel to Mecca once in their life. Pilgrims walk around the Kaaba and wear simple white clothing.

- Slide 2
- Hajj

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Pronounced HAJ. English name: Pilgrimage.

Pilgrimage means a journey to a holy place. Define it, it is not an everyday word.

10 The five images

His to supply. Alex draws or pastes one small picture in each pillar box, five total. Simple symbols count, and so do stick figures.

- Slide 2
- Alex supplies this

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The slide directions ask for an image in each pillar box, so the five pictures are part of the assignment rather than a bonus.

Low-effort symbol ideas if he stalls: Shahada, a speech bubble or the words themselves. Salat, a prayer rug or a small clock showing five marks. Zakat, a hand dropping coins. Sawm, a crescent moon next to a sun going down. Hajj, a black cube with people circling it.

Gap. Flores's slides give the structure but name no textbook, reading or video, so all the history here is standard world-history material rather than his source.

Gap. The slides number the pillars 1 to 5 but do not say which pillar is which number. The standard order is used. If he numbered them in class, use his.

Built from the teachers' own files in Alex's Google Drive and Google Classroom, pulled 20 September 2026. Every answer was generated from those files and then fact checked by a separate pass. The blue blocks are sized to fit a worksheet box; the grey text is context for you.